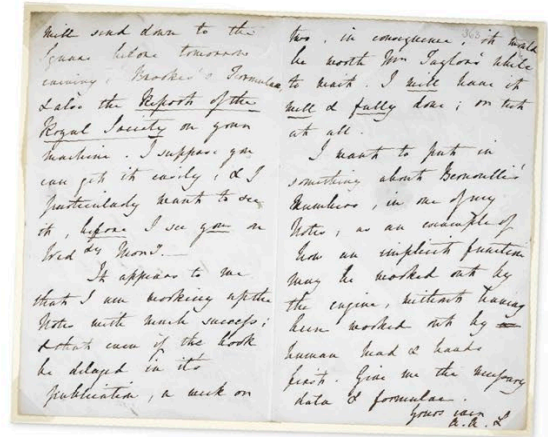




COMPUTER PROGRAMMING

Ada wrote notes on the potential of Babbage's machine including, in the letter below, that calculations "may be worked out by the engine without having been worked out by human head and hands first"—in other words, a computer program.



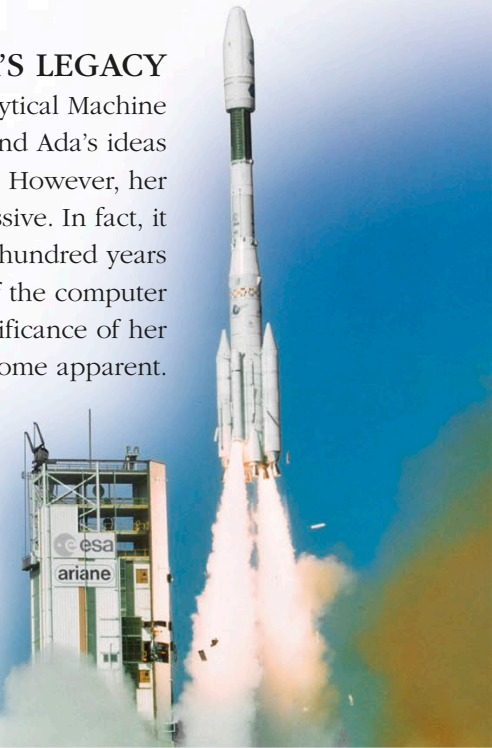
Letter from Ada to Babbage, 1842

ADA'S LEGACY

Sadly, Babbage's Analytical Machine was never built and Ada's ideas remained theoretical. However, her foresight was impressive. In fact, it would take another hundred years and the invention of the computer for the real significance of her work to become apparent.

► IDEAS IN PRACTICE

The concept of programming Ada proposed has influenced applications in many fields, not least aerospace.



1843

Ada publishes her notes on Babbage's Analytical Engine, including algorithms for calculating complex number sequences.

1844

She designs a mathematical model to understand human feelings, calling it a "calculus of the nervous system."

1851

Ada is a gambling addict and creates a mathematical model for betting on horses. It fails.



1852

At the young age of 36, Ada dies from cancer. She is buried next to her famous poet father.